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TRUMP THREATENS KHARG, OIL WELLS

Make a deal soon and open Hormuz or face strikes, US warns

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump yesterday threatened to destroy Iran's oil export hub of Kharg Island, along with its oil wells and power plants, if Tehran does not soon agree to a deal to end the war.

A day after striking a more conciliatory tone and suggesting a deal could be reached this week, Trump wrote on his Truth Social platform that Washington was in "serious discussions" with what he described as "a more reasonable regime" in Tehran, but paired that with a stark warning.

"Great progress has been made but, if for any reason a deal is not shortly reached ... and if the Hormuz Strait is not immediately 'Open for Business,' we will conclude our lovely 'stay' in Iran by blowing up and completely obliterating all of their Electric Generating Plants, Oil Wells and Kharg Island ... which we have purposefully not yet 'touched'," he said.

Regime change claim

Speaking earlier aboard Air Force One, Trump said the United States had effectively achieved "regime change" in Iran following the month-long war launched with Israel, citing the number of Iranian leaders killed.

"We're dealing with different people than anybody's dealt with before ... It's a whole different group," he said, adding that a deal "could be soon".

Trump appeared to link the progress in talks to Iran allowing more oil cargo ships to pass through the Strait of Hormuz, calling it a "sign of respect". However, Iranian officials have not confirmed any negotia-



AFF

People and first-responders walk amidst debris as they gather before a building that was hit by an Israeli airstrike in Beirut's southern suburbs yesterday.

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tions, and the partial disruption of the strait has continued to rattle global markets.

Despite the diplomatic messaging, there was no let-up in hostilities on the ground.

The UAE said its air defences intercepted 11 ballistic missiles and 27 UAVs launched from Iran yesterday. Since the start of the conflict, UAE forces have engaged 425 ballistic missiles, 15 cruise missiles and 1,941 UAVs.

Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Min-

ister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, condemned in the strongest terms the targeting of, and threats to target, civilian infrastructure and civilian facilities in the region, including schools, universities, hospitals, desalination plants, energy facilities, transportation hubs, and residential areas.

Violation of established principles

Such actions constitute a flagrant and grave violation of the established principles and provisions of international law, and cannot, under any circumstances, be accepted or justified.

In Kuwait, an attack on a power and water desalination plant killed an Indian worker and caused significant damage, according to authorities. Kuwait's Ministry of Electricity

said the strike targeted a service building at the facility.

In Lebanon, a UN peacekeeper was killed after a projectile struck a position of the UN force deployed in the south, as Israeli troops battle Iran-backed Hezbollah fighters.

Diplomatic efforts

Pakistan, acting as a go-between, hosted foreign ministers from Saudi Arabia, Turkey and Egypt for talks on de-escalation. Pakistan's foreign minister said both Iran and the United States had expressed confidence in Islamabad's role in facilitating dialogue.

But Iran's parliament speaker accused Washington of using diplomacy as a cover for military escalation, warning of retaliation if US ground forces enter the conflict.

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RESILIENCE BOOST

Dubai approves Dh1b economic support package

DUBAI

BY KHITAM ALAMIR
Chief News Editor

Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council, has approved Dh1 billion in economic facilitation measures to support businesses and enhance market resilience, with implementation set to begin tomorrow for a period of three to six months.

Swift response

Chairing a meeting of Dubai's Executive Council, Sheikh Hamdan said the package aims to strengthen the emirate's economic flexibility, raise readiness levels and ensure a swift response to current requirements.

He added that Dubai remains committed to supporting individuals, families and the business community, enabling them to navigate the current phase with confidence and stability.

During the meeting, officials reviewed Dubai's economic performance for 2025, with growth reaching 5.4 per cent and gross domestic product exceeding Dh937 billion, underscoring the emirate's strong momentum.

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Global markets swing as aluminium and oil surge on Middle East tensions

Commodity rally fuels volatility across equities, with Asia facing sharper pressure

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Global markets swung yesterday as rising oil and aluminium prices, driven by escalating tensions in the Middle East, weighed on investor sentiment and increased volatility across regions.

Stocks in the US traded unevenly, reflecting uncertainty tied to energy markets and geopolitical risks. In Europe, markets edged higher, with shares in the UK, France and Germany posting moderate gains.

Oil drives market sentiment

Oil prices extended gains as supply concerns intensified. US crude rose \$1.95 to \$101.59 a bar-

rel, while Brent crude climbed \$3.41 to \$115.98, compared with around \$70 before the conflict.

"Oil prices extended their upward trajectory on Monday, supported by escalating geopolitical tensions and mounting concerns over supply disruptions," said Joseph Dahrieh, Managing Director at Tickmill.

He pointed to risks around key maritime routes, including the Strait of Hormuz, as a key driver of supply fears.

Aluminium joins the rally

Aluminium prices surged after Iran targeted two major Gulf production facilities, raising concerns over supply disruptions. Prices jumped about 6 per cent early before easing to a 4.2 per cent gain at \$3,435 per tonne.

"Escalation and expansion of the Middle East conflict sent crude oil and aluminium up at the open," said Ipek Ozkardeskaya, analyst at Swissquote Bank. The rise in energy and metals

points to broader supply-side risks. Investors are increasingly positioning for a prolonged conflict, which could keep costs elevated.

"Although we do not expect the conflict to be protracted, we anticipate heightened volatility in the near term," said Xavier Lee, senior equity analyst at Morningstar Research.

Higher oil and metals prices are feeding expectations of rising inflation globally and raising concerns about slower growth, particularly in Asia.

Asia under pressure

Asian stock markets closed broadly lower. Stocks in South Korea and Japan led declines, while Australia also ended in negative territory. Hong Kong slipped, while China managed a slight gain.

The weakness reflects concern over energy supply risks, particularly as access to key shipping routes in the Middle East remains uncertain.

Dubai's economic model thrives amid uncertainty

Emirate reinforces position as a leading economic hub

DUBAI

BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

Dubai is not only weathering current global and regional challenges but is also reinforcing its position as a leading economic hub — driven by a diversified model, agile governance, and deep-rooted collaboration between the public and private sectors, according to business leaders across the emirate's key sectors.

Leaders of business groups operating under the Dubai Chamber of Commerce underscored that Dubai's economic model continues to evolve in response to global shifts, ensuring business continuity, investor confidence, and long-term growth across industries.

Spanning across sectors such as tourism and hospitality,

Dubai's economic model continues to evolve in response to global shifts, ensuring business continuity, investor confidence, and long-term growth across industries.

travel and tourism, real estate, education, health care, technology, trade and logistics, the business leaders emphasised that the emirate's resilience stems from a combination of diversification, strong infrastructure, forward-looking leadership, and an institutional framework designed to anticipate change rather than react to it. This approach, they said, has enabled Dubai to maintain operational stability even as geopolitical tensions and economic uncertainty persist in parts of the world.

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